3.3 Tabulation

A logical step after classifying the statistical data is to present them in the form of tables. A table is a systematic organization of statistical data in rows and columns. The main objective of tabulation is to answer various queries concerning the investigation. Tables are very helpful while carrying out the analysis of collected data and subsequently for drawing inferences from them. It is considered as the final stage in the compilation of data and forms the basis for its further statistical treatment.

Advantages of Tabulation

- It is a logical step of presenting statistical data after classification.
- It enables the reader to understand the required information with ease as the information is contained in rows and columns with figures.
- It enables the investigator to present the data in a brief or condensed and compact form.
- Comparison is made simple by displaying data to be compared in a single table.
- It is easy to remember the data points or items if they are properly placed in the form of table, as it provides a kind of visual aid.
- It facilitates easy computation and helps easy detection of errors and omissions.
- It enables the reader to refer the data to be presented in a manner that suits for further statistical treatment and for making valid conclusions.

3.4 Types of Tables

Statistical tables can be classified under two general categories, namely, general tables and summary tables.

General tables contain a collection of detailed information including all that is relevant to the subject or theme. The main purpose of such tables is to present all the information available on a certain problem at one place for easy reference and they are usually placed in the appendices of reports.

Summary tables are designed to serve some specific purposes. They are smaller in size than general tables, emphasize on some aspect of data and are generally incorporated within the text. The summary tables are also called derivative tables because they are derived from the general tables. The information contained in the summary table aims at analysis and inference. Hence, they are also known as interpretative tables.

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